

Program Logic Models

Four programs. One promise: free, private tools that help people live their best lives.

Advocate's Compass · Beat the Craving · Goal Getter · Care About You

Prepared for Minnesota foundation partners

October 2026 · Updated October 29, 2026 · Program years 2027 to 2029

Our Theory of Change

Apps for Change builds free, ad-free, never-monetized mobile apps that help everyday people improve their well-being and build resilience. Our four apps each address a distinct need: self-advocacy, recovery, personal growth, and social connection. Each is run as its own program with its own population, outcomes, and measures, presented in the logic models that follow.

> **Our overarching theory of change.** IF everyday people have free, private, well-designed tools that turn good intentions into daily action, and a real voice in how those tools are built, THEN they will build the skills, habits, and confidence to advocate for themselves, sustain recovery, reach their goals, and connect with others, leading to healthier, more self-directed lives and stronger Minnesota communities.

What makes our approach different

- **Free forever, with no ads and no upsell.** As a 501(c)(3), we are structurally unable to monetize our users. There is no paywall between a person and the help they need, and crisis tools are never paywalled.
- **Privacy-first by design.** Data is stored securely in the cloud, never sold, never used for advertising, never shared with partners or funders, and deletable by the user at any time. Impact reporting uses only totals, and surveys go by email only to adults who choose to join our Impact Panel.
- **Community-governed.** Quarterly virtual town halls, written into our bylaws, give users a first look at each new app and a place to bring their own app ideas forward. Users help set our roadmap.
- **Built with lived experience.** Focus groups with people in recovery, self-advocates, families, and everyday users shape each app before and after public launch.
- **Accessible from the start.** Apps are tested with disabled users and designed to work with screen readers and plain language.

How to read this document

Each program section opens with who we serve, the need in Minnesota, our theory of change, and the evidence behind it. A one-page logic model follows, moving from **Inputs** (what we invest) to **Activities** (what we do), **Outputs** (what we produce and count), **Outcomes** in three time frames, and **Impact** (the long-term change we contribute to). A measurement table then shows how we will know each outcome is happening. Time frames: short-term means 0 to 6 months of use, intermediate means 6 to 18 months, and long-term means three years or more.

All numeric targets are proposed first-year targets, covering each app's first 12 months after public launch, and will be reviewed by the Board after the first two quarters of real usage data.

Program Portfolio at a Glance

Program	Who it serves	Primary outcome	First-year targets
Advocate's Compass *Launching first, April 2027*	People with disabilities and their families navigating services	People walk into meetings prepared and voice their own priorities	1,500 downloads · 150 monthly active users
Beat the Craving *Public launch early December 2027*	Adults in early recovery from substance use	More cravings managed without a return to use	1,500 downloads · 150 monthly active users
Goal Getter *Public launch mid-September 2027*	Millennial adults pursuing life goals	Goals turned into action and achieved	1,000 downloads · 100 monthly active users

Program	Who it serves	Primary outcome	First-year targets
Care About You *Public launch by November 13, 2027*	Millennial adults seeking connection	More kindness, less loneliness	1,000 downloads · 100 monthly active users
All programs	Minnesota first; available everywhere	Healthier, more self-directed lives	5,000 downloads · 500 monthly active users

First-year targets cover each app's first 12 months after public launch. Because launches run from April to December 2027, the 2027 milestone is 1,000 downloads across the live apps (stretch: 2,500).

Shared Foundation

All four programs run on one organizational foundation. Funding for general operations strengthens every program at once.

Shared inputs

- **People:** Executive Director (about 40 hours per month) with director-level and frontline experience in Minnesota human services; Lead Developer (about 10 hours per month); three-member Board of Directors.
- **Technology:** Expo / React Native apps for iOS and Android; secure cloud hosting; an AI provider used only on request, in one app (Advocate's Compass); Google for Nonprofits.
- **Governance:** Bylaws, Conflict of Interest, Whistleblower, and Document Retention policies; a published Privacy Policy and Terms of Service.
- **Funding:** Individual donations and early operating support; a lean 2027 outreach budget.

Shared activities and outputs (2027)

Activity	Output we will count	2027 target
Quarterly virtual town halls where users get a first look at each new app and propose app ideas	Town halls held; attendance; changes made from community feedback	4 town halls · 10 or more attendees each · 3 or more community-driven changes per app
Focus groups with people who have lived experience	Focus groups held; participants	4 (one per app)
Community partnerships for co-design and referral	Formal partner agreements	2 (one recovery, one disability advocacy)
Accessibility testing with disabled users	Reviews completed; critical issues fixed	1 per app before public launch
Public outreach: op-eds, community events, partner channels	Pieces published; events attended	4 op-eds or articles · 6 events
AFC Impact Panel: short email surveys for adults who choose to join	Members who join; surveys completed	25 members per app in its first year
Annual impact report	Report shared with Board, funders, and users	First report published early 2028

PROGRAM 1

Advocate's Compass

Self-advocacy learning and real-world practice · Launching first, April 2027

Who we serve

People with disabilities, their families, and support persons in Minnesota who navigate services and systems: waiver support-plan meetings, assessments, school IEP meetings, medical appointments, housing and employment conversations. The app is built for anyone who needs to speak up for themselves, and designed from the start to be usable by people with physical, sensory, and cognitive disabilities.

The need

- In 2024, **more than 74,000 Minnesotans** received services through the state's four Medicaid disability waivers: 47,244 on CADI, 25,215 on DD, 998 on BI, and 833 on CAC.[3] Every one of them has recurring planning meetings where decisions about their daily life are made.
- These meetings are high-stakes and often intimidating. People and families face complex rules, professional jargon, frequent staff turnover, and little preparation time. Self-advocacy is rarely taught directly, so many people leave meetings without having raised what matters most to them.
- Without support, people's preferences go unspoken, choices are made **for** them rather than **with** them, and follow-up promises slip through the cracks.

Theory of change

> IF people learn self-advocacy basics, prepare for meetings with plain-language scripts, and track what was promised, THEN they will walk into meetings prepared, voice their own priorities, and see more of their requests acted on, BECAUSE self-advocacy and self-determination are teachable skills that predict better life outcomes for people with disabilities.

Why we believe it will work

- Research on self-determination has found that young adults with cognitive disabilities who had higher self-determination achieved better adult outcomes, including employment and independent living.[12]
- Advocate's Compass is informed by its founder's frontline and director-level experience in Minnesota's waiver system (CADI, BI, DD, and Housing Support), where the gap between what people want and what they are able to say in a meeting is visible every day.
- AI-generated scripts run only when the user asks, are written in plain language, and are presented as a starting point the user edits, so the person stays the author of their own voice.

First-year targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,500
Monthly active users	150
Self-advocacy workshops	4
Formal partner	1 disability advocacy organization
East Metro pilot	1 pilot with East Metro partners, with at least half of participants living in Dakota, Ramsey, or Washington County; timing and size set with partners and funders in early 2027

ADVOCATE'S COMPASS · LOGIC MODEL

> *IF people learn self-advocacy basics, prepare for meetings with plain-language scripts, and track what was promised, THEN they will walk into meetings prepared, voice their own priorities, and see more of their requests acted on, BECAUSE self-advocacy and self-determination are teachable skills that predict better life outcomes for people with disabilities.*

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0 to 6 months)**	**Intermediate (6 to 18 months)**	**Long-term (3+ years)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director with Minnesota waiver-system expertise ▪ Lead Developer (Expo / React Native) ▪ Cloud hosting; AI provider for on-request scripts ▪ Disabled user testers and family advisors ▪ Disability advocacy and East Metro partners (in development) ▪ Privacy Policy and governance policies	▪ Build learning modules on rights, roles, and meeting basics ▪ Build Advocate Now script generator (plain language, on request) ▪ Build meeting tracker: prep, notes, follow-ups, and an optional "How did it go?" rating ▪ Accessibility testing with disabled users (screen readers, cognitive accessibility) ▪ Host virtual self-advocacy workshops with partner ▪ Run an East Metro pilot with partners in Dakota, Ramsey, and Washington counties ▪ Train partner staff and case managers to introduce the app ▪ Focus groups and quarterly town halls	▪ 1,500 downloads; 150 monthly active users ▪ Learning modules completed ▪ Scripts requested (counted, never read) ▪ Meetings prepared, tracked, and rated ▪ 4 workshops; attendee count ▪ East Metro pilot participants, by county ▪ 1 accessibility review completed before public launch ▪ 1 formal partner agreement	▪ Users understand their rights, options, and who decides what ▪ Users identify their top priority before a meeting ▪ Users feel prepared and less anxious going into meetings	▪ Users raise their top priority in meetings ▪ More requests are recorded and acted on ▪ Users track and follow up on commitments ▪ Increased self-advocacy skills and confidence	▪ People direct their own services and plans ▪ Services better match personal goals ▪ Greater independence and community inclusion ▪ Families advocate with less stress	**People with disabilities and their families shaping the decisions that shape their lives.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach, and the Impact Panel) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

ADVOCATE'S COMPASS · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source or tool	When	First-year target
Feel prepared for meetings	% of users who rate their latest meeting 4 or 5 for feeling prepared	Optional "How did it go?" rating in meeting notes (1 to 5)	Monthly	75%
Raise top priority	% of rated meetings where the user marked Yes for raising what mattered most	The same optional rating (Yes, Partly, No)	Monthly	70%
Follow-through	% of logged follow-up items marked complete within 30 days	Aggregate meeting-tracker counts	Monthly	60%
Self-advocacy skills	Change in Speaking Up Check score	Speaking Up Check, AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	60% of panel members improve
Learning	Learning modules completed per active user	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	2 or more per active user
Accessibility	Accessibility issues found and fixed before launch	Accessibility review log	Before launch, then annually	All critical issues fixed
East Metro reach	% of pilot participants living in Dakota, Ramsey, or Washington County	Workshop and panel sign-ups	Each pilot cohort	50% or more

Both meeting measures come from an optional "How did it go?" section in each meeting's notes, and nothing prompts for it. Panel measures come from the AFC Impact Panel, where adults who choose to join answer AFC's own short checks by email when they join and again at 3 and 12 months. Every other measure is a total counted automatically. Nothing inside the apps asks survey questions, no one reads individual entries, and results from groups smaller than 10 are never shown.

PROGRAM 2

Beat the Craving

Coping skills and accountability for recovery · Public launch early December 2027

Who we serve

Adults in Minnesota in early recovery from alcohol or other substance use (roughly the first two years), including people leaving treatment programs and people supported by peer recovery services. The app complements treatment and peer support; it is not a treatment program and makes no clinical claims.

The need

- An estimated **18.1% of Minnesotans age 12 and older, about 876,000 people,** had a substance use disorder in the past year (2022 to 2023), above the national rate of 17.2%.[1]
- Minnesota recorded **994 drug overdose deaths in 2024** (preliminary). That is a real improvement from 1,338 in 2023, but still nearly three lives lost every day.[2]
- Cravings strongly predict a return to use,[11] and they rarely happen during office hours. Structured support often thins out after discharge, leaving people alone with the hardest moments.

Theory of change

> IF people in early recovery build a personal plan of coping strategies, reach for it in the moment a craving hits, and track their own progress, THEN they will manage more cravings without returning to use and build lasting recovery, BECAUSE coping skills are a cornerstone of relapse prevention, and smartphone-based recovery support has improved outcomes in controlled trials.

Why we believe it will work

- In a randomized trial, people leaving residential alcohol treatment who used A-CHESS, a smartphone recovery-support app, reported significantly fewer risky drinking days than a control group over 12 months.[10]
- Ecological momentary assessment studies show that craving measured in daily life predicts later substance use,[11] which is why Beat the Craving is built for the moment, not the weekly appointment.
- Beat the Craving is fully manual, with no AI, by design, and it never sends notifications, so nothing about it pops up on a lock screen. In recovery, trust is the whole value proposition, and users' entries stay private: progress cannot be shared with other people in the current design.

First-year targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,500
Monthly active users	150
Recovery-center outreach visits	4
Formal partner	1 recovery community organization

BEAT THE CRAVING · LOGIC MODEL

> *IF people in early recovery build a personal plan of coping strategies, reach for it in the moment a craving hits, and track their own progress, THEN they will manage more cravings without returning to use and build lasting recovery, BECAUSE coping skills are a cornerstone of relapse prevention, and smartphone-based recovery support has improved outcomes in controlled trials.*

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0 to 6 months)**	**Intermediate (6 to 18 months)**	**Long-term (3+ years)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director with human-services and recovery-adjacent experience ▪ Lead Developer ▪ Cloud hosting (no AI) ▪ People in recovery as co-designers ▪ Recovery community partner (in development) ▪ Crisis and recovery resource directory	▪ Build coping-skill library and personal coping plan ▪ Build craving log: trigger, strategy, outcome ▪ Build days-in-recovery and cravings-beaten counters ▪ Link to 988, AA, and Minnesota recovery resources in-app ▪ Co-design focus groups with people in recovery ▪ Outreach at recovery centers and peer-support programs ▪ Recovery-language review with partner; quarterly town halls	▪ 1,500 downloads; 150 monthly active users ▪ Coping plans created ▪ Cravings logged and strategies used ▪ 4 outreach visits ▪ 1 co-design focus group ▪ 1 formal partner agreement	▪ Users identify personal triggers ▪ Users build a personalized coping plan ▪ Increased confidence in handling cravings	▪ More logged cravings managed without use ▪ Growth in recovery capital: coping skills, support, and confidence	▪ Sustained recovery and fewer recurrences of use ▪ Improved quality of life, health, and stability ▪ Stronger relationships, work, and housing stability	**Fewer Minnesotans lost to addiction and more people thriving in long-term recovery.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach, and the Impact Panel) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

BEAT THE CRAVING · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source or tool	When	First-year target
Coping plan in place	% of new users who save a coping plan within 14 days	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	60%
Cravings managed	% of logged cravings the user marks as managed without use	Aggregate craving-log counts	Monthly	70%
Confidence	% of panel members who agree they can stay on track with their recovery goals	Craving Skills Check (statement 6), AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	Set after two quarters of data
Craving skills	Change in Craving Skills Check score	Craving Skills Check, AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	60% of panel members improve
Engagement	% of users still active at 90 days	Aggregate usage counts	Quarterly	30%
Safety	Crisis resources reachable from every screen in two taps or fewer	Pre-launch review	Before launch, then each release	100%

Panel measures come from the AFC Impact Panel, where adults who choose to join answer AFC's own short checks by email when they join and again at 3 and 12 months. Every other measure is a total counted automatically. Nothing inside the apps asks survey questions, no one reads individual entries, and results from groups smaller than 10 are never shown. Beat the Craving has no third-party analytics or advertising tools, and its days-in-recovery counter is never reported.

PROGRAM 3

Goal Getter

Holistic goal setting, action steps, and progress · Public launch mid-September 2027

Who we serve

Millennial adults (born 1981 to 1996, roughly ages 31 to 46 in 2027) in Minnesota who want structure to move forward on goals across their whole life: finances, career, education, health, relationships, and personal growth.

The need

- Many adults know what they want to change but stall between intention and action. Without structure, goals stay vague, progress is invisible, and motivation fades.
- Stalled goals have real costs: stuck careers, financial strain and instability, and a lower sense of well-being. Most goal and productivity apps that could help are paywalled, ad-supported, or built to maximize screen time rather than real progress.
- Goal Getter offers the core tools of effective goal pursuit, free, with no ads and no upsell: specific goals, planned action steps, milestones, and visible progress.

Theory of change

> IF adults have a free, private tool that turns their goals into specific action steps and milestones with visible progress, THEN they will follow through more consistently, achieve more of what they set out to do, and experience greater well-being and economic stability, BECAUSE specific goals, if-then planning, and progress monitoring are among the best-supported drivers of goal attainment in behavioral science.

Why we believe it will work

- Decades of research show that specific, challenging goals lead to higher performance than vague intentions to "do your best."[6]
- A meta-analysis of 94 studies found that planning when, where, and how to act on a goal had a medium-to-large effect on goal attainment.[7]
- A meta-analysis of 138 studies found that monitoring goal progress promotes goal attainment, especially when progress is physically recorded.[8] Goal Getter's dashboard is built on this principle.

First-year targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,000
Monthly active users	100
Focus group	1
Formal partner	Not planned for 2027

GOAL GETTER · LOGIC MODEL

> *IF adults have a free, private tool that turns their goals into specific action steps and milestones with visible progress, THEN they will follow through more consistently, achieve more of what they set out to do, and experience greater well-being and economic stability, BECAUSE specific goals, if-then planning, and progress monitoring are among the best-supported drivers of goal attainment in behavioral science.*

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0 to 6 months)**	**Intermediate (6 to 18 months)**	**Long-term (3+ years)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director ▪ Lead Developer ▪ Cloud hosting (no AI) ▪ Millennial user testers ▪ Behavioral-science design principles	▪ Build goal wizard across life areas ▪ Build action steps, milestones, and reminders ▪ Build progress dashboard ▪ Focus group with millennial users ▪ Outreach through op-eds, community events, and partners' networks ▪ Demo new features at quarterly town halls	▪ 1,000 downloads; 100 monthly active users ▪ Goals created with action steps ▪ Action steps and milestones completed ▪ 1 focus group ▪ Features added from user ideas	▪ Users set specific, measurable goals ▪ Goals broken into concrete next steps ▪ Greater clarity and motivation	▪ Users reach milestones consistently ▪ Higher self-efficacy ▪ Regular habit of reviewing progress	▪ Users achieve meaningful personal, career, and financial goals ▪ Greater well-being ▪ Greater economic stability and self-direction	**Minnesotans living purpose-driven lives with greater well-being and economic self-sufficiency.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach, and the Impact Panel) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

GOAL GETTER · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source or tool	When	First-year target
Specific goals set	% of active users with at least one goal broken into action steps	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	75%
Follow-through	% of users active in their first 90 days who complete at least one milestone in that time	Aggregate usage counts	Quarterly	50%
Goal progress	Change in Goal Progress Check score	Goal Progress Check, AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	55% of panel members improve
Well-being	Change in well-being score	AFC Well-Being Check, AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	55% improve or hold steady
Goal achievement	% of panel members who say they reached a goal that matters to them	AFC Impact Panel question	12 months	50%

Panel measures come from the AFC Impact Panel, where adults who choose to join answer AFC's own short checks by email when they join and again at 3 and 12 months. Every other measure is a total counted automatically. Nothing inside the apps asks survey questions, no one reads individual entries, and results from groups smaller than 10 are never shown.

PROGRAM 4

Care About You

Kindness ideas, scheduled into real life · Public launch by November 13, 2027

Who we serve

Millennial adults in Minnesota who want to be more connected to the people around them and to do more good, including people who feel isolated or lonely.

The need

- In 2023 to 2024, **18% of U.S. adults** said they felt lonely a lot of the previous day; among U.S. men ages 15 to 34, the figure was **25%**, one of the highest rates among wealthy nations.[4]
- The U.S. Surgeon General has called loneliness an epidemic, warning that lacking social connection carries a mortality risk comparable to smoking up to 15 cigarettes a day.[5]
- Most people want to be kind, but intentions get lost in busy schedules. Without a nudge and a plan, the call never gets made and the card never gets sent, and both the giver and receiver stay more isolated.

Theory of change

> IF people receive easy, personal kindness ideas and schedule them straight into their calendars, THEN they will perform more regular acts of kindness, which strengthens their relationships and reduces their own loneliness, BECAUSE doing kind acts reliably improves the giver's well-being, and scheduled plans turn good intentions into action.

Why we believe it will work

- A meta-analysis found that performing acts of kindness has a small-to-medium positive effect on the well-being of the person doing them.[9]
- Planning exactly when to act sharply increases follow-through on intentions;[7] Care About You puts each idea on the user's calendar for that reason.
- Care About You has no AI. Ideas come from a library built into the app, users add only the people they choose, and the app never reads their phone's contacts.

First-year targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,000
Monthly active users	100
Focus group	1
Formal partner	Not planned for 2027

CARE ABOUT YOU · LOGIC MODEL

> *IF people receive easy, personal kindness ideas and schedule them straight into their calendars, THEN they will perform more regular acts of kindness, which strengthens their relationships and reduces their own loneliness, BECAUSE doing kind acts reliably improves the giver's well-being, and scheduled plans turn good intentions into action.*

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0 to 6 months)**	**Intermediate (6 to 18 months)**	**Long-term (3+ years)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director ▪ Lead Developer ▪ Cloud hosting (no AI) ▪ Millennial user testers ▪ Calendar integration (adds events, never reads them)	▪ Build a library of kindness ideas to browse and save ▪ Build one-tap calendar scheduling ▪ Build kindness log and monthly recap ▪ Focus group with millennial users ▪ Seasonal community kindness campaigns; quarterly town halls	▪ 1,000 downloads; 100 monthly active users ▪ Kindness ideas saved ▪ Acts scheduled and completed ▪ 1 focus group ▪ 2 community campaigns	▪ Users plan and complete acts of kindness regularly ▪ More frequent, intentional contact with others	▪ Reduced loneliness ▪ Stronger, more reciprocal relationships ▪ Greater sense of meaning and fulfillment	▪ Sustained flourishing ▪ Kindness as a lasting habit ▪ Stronger community ties	**More connected, caring Minnesota communities where fewer people feel alone.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach, and the Impact Panel) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

CARE ABOUT YOU · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source or tool	When	First-year target
Kindness in action	% of scheduled acts marked complete	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	50%
Frequency	Average completed acts per active user per month	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	4
Loneliness	% of panel members lonely when they join whose answer moves at least one step toward less lonely	Connection and Kindness Check (statement 7), AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	50% of those members
Well-being	Change in well-being score	AFC Well-Being Check, AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	55% improve or hold steady
Connection and kindness	Change in Connection and Kindness Check score	Connection and Kindness Check, AFC Impact Panel	Joining, 3 and 12 months	55% of panel members improve
Engagement	% of users still active at 90 days	Aggregate usage counts	Quarterly	30%

Panel measures come from the AFC Impact Panel, where adults who choose to join answer AFC's own short checks by email when they join and again at 3 and 12 months. Every other measure is a total counted automatically. Nothing inside the apps asks survey questions, no one reads individual entries, and results from groups smaller than 10 are never shown.

Evaluation Plan

Our evaluation is designed to be rigorous enough to learn from and honest enough to report, while never compromising the privacy promise that makes our apps trustworthy. It grows in three phases as the organization grows.

Phase	What we measure	How
Phase 1 · 2027 public launches	Reach, engagement, and early outcomes for every program	Aggregate usage totals; the AFC Impact Panel, with short email surveys (the AFC Well-Being Check plus each app's own check) when members join and at 3 and 12 months; the optional meeting rating in Advocate's Compass; town hall and focus group feedback
Phase 2 · 2028	Whether outcomes hold at 12 months and differ by user group	Twelve-month panel results; review of results with partners and lived-experience advisors; first published annual impact report
Phase 3 · 2029	Stronger evidence of effectiveness for the two most mature programs	Formal before-and-after evaluation with a Minnesota university or independent evaluation partner, with ethics review where required; individual answers shared only with members' permission

How the AFC Impact Panel works

- **Who joins:** adults 18 and older who use an AFC app and choose to join, through a link in each app's Settings, the app's welcome email, or our website.
- **What we ask for:** a first name, an email address, and county of residence, plus whether they want to be named or anonymous. Never a last name.
- **How often:** a survey of about 3 minutes when they join and again at 3 and 12 months, with the AFC Well-Being Check for everyone plus the check for each app they use.
- **What members get:** their own well-being snapshot after each survey, first access to new apps, results before anyone else, and, if they want it, recognition in our annual impact report. Every benefit is free.
- **How answers are kept:** under a panel code, apart from names and emails, never linked to app accounts, and reported only as totals.
- **County reporting:** county of residence lets us report to community foundations for the areas they serve, once 10 or more people there have answered.

Our data commitments

- **Opt-in only.** Outcome surveys go by email only to adults who choose to join the AFC Impact Panel. Nothing inside the apps asks survey questions, and members can skip any question or leave at any time.
- **Aggregate only.** We report totals and percentages, never individual entries or answers, and suppress any group smaller than 10 people so no one can be identified.
- **Minimum necessary.** We collect only what a measure needs and nothing for advertising, fundraising, or AI training.
- **Aligned with our policies.** Evaluation operates within our published Privacy Policy and Document Retention Policy, and under the Board's oversight.
- **Shared back.** Results are presented at town halls and in our annual impact report, so users see what their participation made possible.

AFC's own measures

AFC wrote five short checks of its own, so no permissions are needed and every question can be shown to funders, partners, and town hall attendees. Each check asks how much members agree with a few plain-language statements about the past month, from Strongly disagree to Strongly agree, and a higher score always means a better result. The full checks, scoring rules, and development record are in *AFC Impact Measures*, version 1.1.

Check	What it covers	Statements	Who answers
AFC Well-Being Check	How life is going, enjoyment, support, stress, and hope	5	Every panel member, all four apps
Speaking Up Check	Preparing for meetings, speaking up, and following through	6	Advocate's Compass members
Goal Progress Check	Setting goals, taking steps, and believing they can reach them	6	Goal Getter members
Connection and Kindness Check	Closeness, kindness given and received, and loneliness	7	Care About You members
Craving Skills Check	Coping skills, triggers, support, and confidence	6	Beat the Craving members

Because the checks are new, each one is tested before its app's panel opens: a read-aloud test with 3 to 5 people from the app's target group, an accessibility review with disabled testers, and partner reviews of the Speaking Up and Craving Skills Checks. Once 50 members have answered a check, we test whether its statements hang together (Cronbach's alpha of .70 or higher). Results are labeled as self-reported AFC measures, and the Board reviews the scoring cutoffs after the first year of results.

Assumptions and External Factors

Key assumptions

- People in our target groups have smartphones and will try a free app recommended by a trusted source.
- Enough users will join the AFC Impact Panel (we plan for 25 members per app in its first year) to produce meaningful results, reported only once 10 or more people have answered.
- AFC's own checks prove clear and consistent once tested with members: read-aloud tests before each panel opens, and a consistency check once 50 members have answered.
- Partner organizations will refer participants and co-host workshops, outreach, and an East Metro pilot of Advocate's Compass.
- AI services used on request remain affordable for a nonprofit at our scale.
- Town halls and focus groups will surface ideas that measurably improve the apps.

External factors we monitor

- **Policy change:** Medicaid and disability-waiver reforms in Minnesota may change how meetings and services work; Advocate's Compass content will be updated accordingly.
- **Digital divide:** Access to devices, data plans, and digital skills varies; partners help us reach people who are less connected.
- **App store and AI rules:** Changes to Apple, Google, or AI regulations could affect features or timelines.
- **Stigma:** Stigma around addiction and disability can deter use; privacy and respectful, person-first language help counter it.
- **Funding climate:** Our pace of development depends on growing a diverse base of individual, foundation, and corporate support.

Capacity and Growth

Apps for Change is a lean, early-stage organization: our Executive Director contributes about 40 hours per month and our Lead Developer about 10 hours per month, supported by a three-member Board. We are honest about that capacity, and it is exactly why foundation support makes an outsized difference. Each investment below directly expands what the logic models can deliver.

Investment	What it makes possible	Programs
Contract development hours	Faster, steadier releases and bug fixes after public launch	All
Paid accessibility testing	Stipends for disabled testers so lived experience is compensated, not volunteered	All; especially Advocate's Compass
Lived-experience focus group stipends	Co-design with people in recovery, self-advocates, and families	All
Evaluation tools and partner	Survey tools in 2027 and an independent evaluation partner by 2029	All
Outreach and partner workshops	Self-advocacy workshops, recovery-center outreach, partner training, and the East Metro pilot	Advocate's Compass, Beat the Craving

Looking ahead: community features (Phase 3, gated)

Peer connection is a powerful driver of recovery, belonging, and motivation, and it remains a long-term part of our vision. We see a future social community layer as a real opportunity to deepen outcomes across all four programs. Because shared content brings new safety responsibilities, it is deliberately gated: it will move forward only with dedicated funding, legal review, a full Trust & Safety plan (moderation, abuse reporting, crisis protocols, and age safeguards), and formal Board approval. It is not part of the logic models above. Each 2027 town hall asks users whether they want it and what would make it feel safe.

Sources

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AFC's measures

- Apps for Change, *AFC Impact Measures*, version 1.1, October 29, 2026: the full text, scoring rules, and development record of AFC's five checks.